COUNTRY REPORTS: SENEGAL

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Status report

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Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

The committee created to coordinate the state's digital projects has not started work. GouvNum, a digital governance committee set up in March 2026 to coordinate them, was still being described by the government as due to become operational in the near future, as the body overseeing all digital transformation initiatives across the country, five months after its creation (August 2026). It is chaired by the Prime Minister and sits apart from the Conseil national du numérique, twenty experts from the public sector, private enterprise and civil society inaugurated on 2 October 2025 to advise on technology trends, digital policy and structural projects.

The strategy they serve is the New Deal Technologique Horizon 2034, launched in February 2025, which replaced Senegal Numérique 2025 and makes interoperability of government information systems, digital public infrastructure and a centralised integrated digital platform its core pillars. It was launched on 24 February 2025 by President Bassirou Diomaye Faye under the Vision Sénégal 2050 framework, and rests on four pillars: digital sovereignty, digitisation of the administration and public services, development of the digital economy, and positioning Senegal as a leading African digital hub. Its predecessor, Digital Senegal 2025, adopted in 2016, covered network infrastructure, end-user equipment, cybersecurity, e-government, e-commerce, digital market regulation and skills. Prime Minister Ousmane Sonko launched the New Deal's 12 structuring projects, worth about 1,100bn FCFA over 2025–2034, at the strategy's first anniversary in March 2026.

Below the headline strategy the coverage is uneven. The Justice Sectoral Policy Letter for 2025-2029 provides for a national digital judicial-record platform and progressive digitisation of the courts, while no national artificial intelligence plan has been adopted, the Head of State having instructed government in July 2026 to accelerate its deployment. Senegal has an established institution with a GovTech or digital government mandate, but it publishes nothing about its work (2025). And the flagship programme itself contains no explicit digital-rights provisions (March 2025). The prime minister's policy statement of 8 September 2026 refocused the priorities of the New Deal Technologique, and expressions of interest were called for an infrastructure-needs study for the national interoperability platform, closing 7 October 2026.

Legislation and regulation

Senegal has enacted no law defining digital identity: the feasibility study for the Identifiant Numérique National found the necessary legal texts absent (2022). Others are stuck short of the statute book too. The bill computerising civil-status management had not been adopted as of August 2025, with its implementing and register-reconstitution decrees outstanding alongside it, though the Nékkal programme has produced validated texts and a national civil-status strategy (June 2026). A revised personal data protection bill is finalised and awaiting a vote in the National Assembly (2026). A draft law creating an independent media regulator with a remit over digital platforms and social

networks was published in January 2025. The critical-infrastructure framework is the one that cleared: the Assembly adopted law n° 25/2026 on critical information infrastructure and digital security unanimously on 20 August 2026. Bill 21/2026, extending the validity of the first ECOWAS biometric cards, was sent back to committee by the plenary on 29 September 2026, the law committee's chair raising procurement, the use of national firms and foreign custody of citizens' data.

What is in force is older and broader than the estate it governs. Act No. 2008-12 of 25 January 2008, with implementing Decree No. 2008-721, governs the processing of personal data by the state, local authorities and private bodies, and makes biometric data and national identity numbers subject to prior authorisation. Law No. 2008-08 of 25 January 2008 on electronic transactions sets the legal frame for electronic commerce, electronic proof and electronic signatures, and its implementing Decree No. 2008-718 gives consumers seven working days to withdraw from a contract concluded electronically. Digital payments, drones, e-waste and consumer protection in e-commerce are also regulated under Law No. 2021-25 on prices and consumer protection. Decree No. 2019-591 organises the telecoms regulator ARTP, and Decree No. 2022-1814 assigns e-commerce to the digital ministry. The Startup Act, Law No. 2020-01 of 6 January 2020, gives young innovative firms a statutory regime, and its implementing decree was adopted only in January 2025, five years on.

No law in force imposes a general data localisation requirement: the 2008 law restricts transfers to countries without an adequate level of protection and requires prior notification to the data protection authority (2024). The rule is coming in law n° 25/2026, whose bill requires data produced, collected or held by state services, or by private partners carrying out a public-service mission, to be hosted and processed on national territory (July 2026); the Assembly adopted it on 20 August 2026, and no promulgated text had been published as at September 2026. Some binding rule is not Senegalese: the UEMOA fintech regulation, in force since 23 January 2024, governs payment providers with deposit-protection and anti-money-laundering requirements. At the other end, the Criminal Procedure Code still requires case files and procès-verbaux to be recorded on paper, each page signed, and the originals sent physically to prosecutors.

Data protection

The data protection commission handled 195 files between April and June 2026, 154 declarations and 41 authorisation requests, and received eight complaints, but nobody measures whether the rules are followed: compliance with the regime is not monitored, the regime publishes no compliance reporting, and the oversight authority's own documentation is held internally and not published, even though the law is in force and assessed as effective rather than merely enacted, and an authority is in place (2025).

The regime rests on Law No. 2008-12 of 25 January 2008, operative and never amended as at March 2025; a revision is finalised and awaiting a vote in the National Assembly. The act carries no explicit breach-notification provision, and no general statutory duty to notify the authority or those affected. Enforcement sits with the Commission de Protection des Données Personnelles, created by the 2008 law and operational since 2014, which authorises the processing of personal and biometric data, conducts inspections, and can impose administrative fines or suspend processing. There is no dedicated tribunal: its decisions are challenged before the administrative chamber of the Cour Suprême, and breaches of the 2008 law prosecuted in the criminal courts.

The framework was tested by the breach of the identity agency DAF in February 2026, and the state's response has been narrow: its communiqués assert only that the integrity of personal data "demeure intacte" and "est strictement préservée", say nothing about confidentiality or volume, and at no point deny that data was exfiltrated (April 2026). When the directorate's head confirmed in September that it had been a cyberattack, he said only that no personal data was compromised and that the files were intact and unchanged.

New systems arrive with protection attached unevenly. Civil-status digitisation carries an information-system security policy and a personal-data-protection strategy developed with the data protection commission (August 2025), and the digital ministry has adopted a Plan d'actions national de protection des enfants en ligne, built on nine axes, committing to prevent cyberbullying, counter online child sexual exploitation and build the capacity of families and teachers (July 2026). Against that, the convention pairing the state digital operator with the universal health-cover agency states its personal-data commitment as an intention rather than referring it to the data protection authority (July 2026), and the new biometric register of artisanal gold miners was announced with no data-protection provision and no role for the data protection commission (August 2026).

Regional collaboration

The regional digital instruments Senegal is party to are not paid for by the region. The ECOWAS Community budget for 2026-2028 carries no disaggregated digital or ICT appropriation anywhere in its expenditure structure, and the only ICT-named programme line in it, Youth Entrepreneurship in ICT, shows nil from 2024 through the 2026, 2027 and 2028 estimates.

The perimeter has also shrunk. Burkina Faso, Mali and Niger left ECOWAS and its WURI identity programme in 2024, and have since assembled a rival Alliance of Sahel States credential stack — a common biometric passport launched in January 2025 and AES-aligned national identity cards since, giving passport-free travel among the three outside the ECOWAS scheme. The ECOWAS rail Senegal sits on now has three fewer participants.

Senegal is bound by what the bloc adopts. The ECOWAS Digital Sector Development Strategy 2024-2029 was adopted on 4 October 2024 at Cotonou by ministers who at the same meeting required full implementation of the ECOWAS Roaming Regulation by all mobile operators by the end of 2025 and adopted a directive on confidence-building measures in the cyber and ICT field, to be implemented "without delay upon its publication". Under the ECOWAS and World Bank WURI programme, a cross-border identity interoperability strategy and 2026 work plan were validated in March 2026, working toward mutual recognition of national identity credentials — an objective rather than an adopted standard.

The one border where something is being installed is with The Gambia. The two customs administrations agreed in July 2026 to install the GAINDE customs system at three shared border posts within three months and to deploy SIGMAT for real-time tracking of transit consignments, and to replace transit agents with a Single Administrative Document, end double escorting on the Wellingara Corridor and reactivate the EnCen intelligence-sharing platform. Further out, Senegal hosted a Smart Africa and UNESCO regional data-governance workshop in May 2026 bringing in six neighbouring states, and its digital minister spoke for the Global AI Capacity-Building Cooperation Network at the Global AI Dialogue in Geneva in July 2026, calling for cooperation that lets developing countries benefit from artificial intelligence. The steering committee of the digital cooperation memorandum with The Gambia held its first session at Banjul on 29 August 2026.

Standards

Senegal is drawing up the common reference framework for its state systems after building the systems. A Government Enterprise Architecture is being stood up under the New Deal Technologique, spanning public policies, business processes, data, applications and the state's digital infrastructure, with the national interoperability platform, PINS, as one of its four components alongside national digital identity, a government cloud and data governance. A full inventory of state information systems was launched at the project's workshop of 29 July 2026, where interim diagnostic results were presented, with Sénégal Numérique S.A. as implementer and the PAENS programme as funder.

What it has to correct is the absence of shared rule underneath. A national data strategy does exist and is published: the 2023-2028 strategy commits under its first orientation to a legal framework adapted to data opening and to a national data-sharing platform, to drafting a data law and to standing up a data governance authority. What the comparative assessment records is that neither the authority nor the law has followed: Senegal has no data governance institution recorded, no government interoperability framework recorded, and neither a government open source software policy nor any recorded open source adoption (2025). The interoperability platform itself is built on X-Road, with a roadmap of a 2024-2025 pilot and national deployment across 2025-2027 validated by the COCOOR inter-ministerial coordination committee in September 2025.

Where published standards do bite, they are mostly sectoral or regional. The telecoms regulator has deployed eight digital regulatory platforms — SUNUCARTO for national digital-infrastructure mapping, RESEAU for quality of experience, CATALOGUE, DMARKET for tariffs, NUMFLEX for number portability, CLAIMS, FSVA and VCN (January 2026). Payment providers are held to the UEMOA fintech regulation in force since 23 January 2024, and the health-coverage payments platform is aligned to the UN's nine Principles for Responsible Digital Payments. Public procurement has moved to a single electronic platform, APPEL, live since 15 October 2025.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Senegal's Digital Freedom score fell 27.3 points over 2014-2023 to 45.6 out of 100.0, 30th of 54 African countries and the fourth-largest ten-year decline among the 96 indicators in its profile. The wider civic picture moves the same way: Freedom of Association & Assembly is the second most deteriorated governance measure of the decade, down 37.5 points to 37.5 out of 100.0, Media Freedom fell 17.9 points to 60.0, and Civil Society Space fell 8.2 points to 81.5, all at 2023. Freedom of Expression & Belief remains one of the country's ten best-scoring measures at 87.5, 7th of 54, though it too fell 7.5 points.

Accountability & Transparency is Senegal's worst-scoring governance sub-category at 48.4 out of 100.0, 15th of 54, after falling 8.4 points over the decade (2023), and the country scores far better on the accessibility of public records than on their disclosure. The formal right of access arrived late, with an access to information law adopted in August 2025, welcomed by civil society as a transparency measure. The machinery for hearing from citizens is thinner than its existence suggests: a citizen feedback mechanism is in place but meets none of the five further measures applied to it, and an online citizen participation platform is in use but meets only one of six (2025).

Where debate does happen it has bite. Consumer bodies, fintechs and some lawmakers opposed the proposed levy on mobile-money transfers as likely to reverse financial-inclusion gains and push users back to cash, proposing alternatives. Public argument about artificial intelligence frames the challenge as building an ethical framework and asks what strategy is open to Senegal and Africa in the face of Chinese and American corporate domination of the technology (February 2025), and the digital ministry convened public administration, universities, the private sector and other partners on 1–2 July 2026 to set the country's AI and data priorities. The government's own framing of connectivity is territorial equity, with the minister stating that internet access "is no longer a luxury, it is a citizen's right" (April 2026).

Finance

Financial sustainability

Senegal's 2026 finance law pays for its Digital Governance and Sovereignty programme mostly with debt: its external-projects annex carries XOF 30.5bn of loans from the World Bank, BOAD and the African Development Bank on the programme, against XOF 3.0bn of the state's own non-personnel credits, and a XOF 14.0bn KfW grant for the administration digitalisation programme PRODAP against a state counterpart of XOF 126m (2026).

The state's own money is 28.8% of the digital lines of the 2026 budget as voted, XOF 22.0bn of XOF 76.5bn excluding personnel, against 31.2% in 2025.

What the treasury carries itself is mostly transfers to the bodies that run the estate: XOF 5.77bn to the state digital operator SENUM SA and XOF 2.3bn to the universal-service fund FDSUT in 2026. What it votes it largely spends: the digital-economy programme took up XOF 8.6bn of its XOF 9.65bn of domestic non-personnel credits in 2025, after XOF 11.96bn against XOF 11.59bn in 2024. The sector also pays in: the telecoms regulator's radio-spectrum fees brought the budget XOF 45.6bn in 2025, 131% of target.

The largest external windows close in 2028, and what follows them is not yet designed. The World Bank's digital-economy acceleration project closes on 31 May 2028 and carries a target for a financing model under which the health ministry takes the staff and system costs the project funds onto national health financing after closure, a model not developed as at October 2025; the same restructuring cancelled the planned public-private partnerships to operate SENUM's fibre and to build the backbone's missing links, the government not being ready to support the SENUM reform (2026). The Diamniadio technology park, about 95% built, was held up in May 2026 by its AfDB closing date and by unfinished concession talks with BOAD.

MoUs and other agreements

UNDP and the government signed a memorandum of understanding in April 2026 covering digital governance, digital inclusion and artificial intelligence — the most recent of a short run of agreements that commit no money. Senegal and Finland opened cooperation on cybersecurity, sovereign and resilient digital infrastructure, data-centre modernisation and AI-ready infrastructure at political consultations in Dakar in March 2026, framed under the New Deal Technologique and the EU's Global Gateway. A services-federation memorandum with Mauritania was signed through OPTIC during Prime Minister Ousmane Sonko's visit in January 2025, and an October 2024 memorandum with Google set out a sovereign cloud keeping the state's critical data hosted onshore. None of the four states a sum, a timetable or an obligation to deliver.

New investments

Thirty-five distinct digital financing commitments to Senegal are on record, made between 2015 and 2026 with windows running out to 2034 and worth roughly US$1.5 billion between them — money committed rather than money moved. Chinese state finance is the largest single source in that record, around a third of the total across four commitments. Grants outnumber debt by count, twenty of the thirty-five, but the debt carries most of the money.

Senegal's own 2026 digital budget is CFA 81.06 billion, up 38.7% on the year before, while the World Bank alone has committed CFA 95.05 billion to the 2026 digital programme. BOAD is lending XOF 30.9 billion, about US$52 million, to accelerate the digital transformation of public services over 2026–2028.

The Chinese money is older and larger. China Eximbank lent RMB 530 million, about US$95 million, in November 2015 for the third phase of the e-government project, after two earlier phases that laid some 1,500 km of fibre across the regional capitals and built the government intranet and its data centres. A RMB 200 million grant and a RMB 1.05 billion concessional loan were signed on the same day in February 2018 for the first phase of Smart Senegal, and about US$148 million more is financing the restructuring and expansion of the Diamniadio national data centre under the second.

Commercial lenders have gone to the operators: IFC, British International Investment and Proparco arranged an €87 million sustainability-linked loan for Sonatel in May 2024, its pricing tied to network expansion targets, and BII put US$31.7 million of debt into Wave Mobile Money in June 2025.

The government's own frame is the Agenda de Transformation Numérique, which carries 1,105 billion FCFA across twelve priority programmes over 2025–2034; a US$10 million Gates Foundation grant funds a universal digital ID, an AI hub for health and agriculture and a delivery unit inside it, and DER/FJ has launched Catalyst, a US$50 million pre-seed and seed fund for Senegalese startups.

By value the money concentrates on connectivity, technology parks and government digitalisation; statistical capacity, data exchange and health information systems attract the least between them. A US$300m investment commitment by an American cybersecurity company was presented to the president in Washington on 14 September 2026; no contract is on record.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Sonatel commissioned the country's landing station on the 2Africa submarine cable in December 2025, a system of 45,000km whose 180 Tbps nominal capacity is about ten times that of earlier cables, and the first to reach every African coast; the landing is run on a carrier-neutral, open-access basis, so operators other than Sonatel can buy capacity through it.

Capacity is not what limits this. 4G networks cover 97% of the population, and GSMA still finds a 54% mobile-internet usage gap (2025); it counts about 52% of the population using mobile services and 42% on mobile broadband (2025). About 75% of men and 61% of women own a smartphone, with handset affordability the principal constraint on further growth (2024), even though mobile data prices sit well below the African average.

Redundancy has improved on land as well as at sea: Phase3 Telecom and Sonatel opened a 3,500km terrestrial fibre route from Lagos to Dakar in May 2025, giving Senegal an overland alternative to the kind of subsea breaks that disrupted West African traffic in 2024. Domestic traffic has somewhere to meet onshore: two internet exchange points operate in Dakar, SENIX and HubSIX (2024).

The newest layer is satellite. Sonatel launched Senegal's first satellite internet offer in January 2026 on Eutelsat's Konnect service, and in July 2026 rebuilt its 1972-era Gandoul teleport in Thiès with 16 new antennas and a Tier III technical room, turning it into a gateway between Eutelsat OneWeb's low-earth-orbit constellation and the terrestrial network. Starlink operates under a five-year renewable licence, and the state has negotiated 5,000 kits at a preferential price with the aim of connecting a million Senegalese free of charge; the first were handed over at Kolda, in Casamance, in April 2026.

The distance still to cover is visible in two places: rural households are barely connected at all (December 2025), and while Senegal's Mobile Communications score reached 83.4 out of 100.0 in 2023, 7th of 54 and the second most improved of the index's 96 indicators, Internet & Computers scored 37.0 and ranked 21st in the same year. The government plans to connect 6,888 schools to broadband, with satellite for more than 2,000 further schools, under its 2025-2029 digital education strategy (September 2026). The Senegalese and Malian state fibre operators inaugurated the interconnection of their national backbones at the Kidira-Diboli border crossing on 5 October 2026. The Supreme Court suspended Starlink's provisional licence on 7 September 2026, and the internet exchange point had 260 Gbps of capacity and six members in September 2026.

Data Storage

Government data and digital platforms have sat on foreign servers, to be centralised onshore; the New Deal sets a target of 100% of sensitive government data hosted inside the country (August 2026).

What it has to host that data in is the national data centre at Diamniadio, the hosting base for government digital services (2024), built by Huawei under Chinese financing and inaugurated in June 2021. The commercial estate around it is a handful of small facilities, all in Dakar (2024), and is growing slowly: PAIX Data Centres broke ground at Les Mamelles in January 2025 on a 1.2MW building with over 900 square metres of colocation space, due online in 2026, and AWS made a Wavelength Zone in Dakar generally available in April 2025, the first in West Africa. The interior minister told deputies in September 2026 that the government is developing national storage including a data centre for civil-status, identity-card and passport data.

The sovereign cloud is being assembled with foreign partners rather than domestic ones: a memorandum with Google in October 2024 to keep the state's critical data onshore, an accord with Huawei in June 2025 whose first element is modernisation of Senegal's data centres, and a platform in testing with Alibaba, worked jointly with Senegalese engineers, to run accreditation, security and logistics for the Dakar 2026 Youth Olympic Games (April 2026).

None of it yet rests on a residency rule in force. The 2008 data protection law imposes no general data localisation requirement, restricting transfers instead to countries without an adequate level of protection, and no policy governing where government data may be hosted was evidenced in the 2025 GovTech Maturity Index. The rule is coming by statute: the National Assembly adopted law n° 25/2026 on 20 August 2026, whose bill requires data held by state services to be hosted and processed on national territory (July 2026); no promulgated text had been published as at September 2026.

The capacity question is the harder one. Pre-launch analysis of the New Deal named a storage and compute infrastructure deficit among the things that limit it (February 2025); the civil-status system, for one, runs on 6 servers totalling 1,000 TB across 3 hosting sites (August 2025) — on a grid where most firms experience outages. A capacity expansion of the Stellarix data centre at Diamniadio was reported on 2 October 2026.

Energy

Power interruption is the normal operating condition for Senegalese business: the World Bank's Enterprise Survey, covering 603 firms interviewed between July 2024 and March 2025, found 55% of firms experiencing outages, averaging 1.8 in a typical month.

The wider access picture is one of steady but partial progress. Senegal's Access to Energy score stood at 49.4 out of 100.0 in 2023, 18th of 54, after rising 5.7 points over the decade, and while most of the population now has a connection, rural access remains far behind urban (2023). Rural electrification is framed by a comprehensive national programme run by the agency ASER, with significant off-grid deployment under way (2024).

Price is regulated and tiered: SENELEC bills residential customers from about XOF 82/kWh for the first 150 kWh, rising to XOF 159/kWh in higher tiers, at an average residential price of XOF 109.39/kWh in December 2025. Renewables account for about 24% of generation capacity (2021).

Operators build around the grid rather than depend on it: Sonatel runs more than 1,000 solar-powered network sites in Senegal (2025).

Technical Capacity

The capability to produce Senegal's identity documents does not sit inside the Senegalese state: card production and key technical infrastructure for the national identity system are contracted to Malaysia's Iris Corporation Berhad, under an arrangement running since 2016 and renewed in 2021, leaving day-to-day operation with the DAF but production capability with a foreign vendor (2025).

The newer layers are being staffed the same way. Alibaba is training a cohort of Senegalese cloud engineers alongside the sovereign-cloud work for Dakar 2026 (April 2026), and the June 2025 accord with Huawei commits to high-level training and skills transfer for Senegalese personnel in cloud computing, artificial intelligence and 5G.

Government's own readiness reads better on administration than on technology. Public administration is among Senegal's strongest governance sub-categories (2023) and an established public-sector innovation institution sits behind both a strategy and a programme, with digital skills as its focus (2025), but the digital skills programme for public servants does not go beyond basic skills, and its documentation is unpublished (2025).

The private base is thin at the top end: public contributor trackers list Senegal's active open-source developers in the hundreds (2025). Institutional building continues around it — the digital technology park at Diamniadio has been under development since 2015 and its financing commitment remains open, and Senegal presented a national AI Factory to an international audience in Tokyo on 3 August 2026.

Cybersecurity

Three central Senegalese state systems have been breached inside a year: the DGID tax authority lost roughly 1TB of data including tax declarations and identity documents in 2025, and the DAF biometric and identity agency was breached in February 2026, with the air transport directorate named alongside them among the services attacked (August 2026).

The DAF intrusion was ransomware, and it halted production of national identity cards in early February 2026; production resumed on 1 April 2026, eight weeks on. A security researcher examined the samples the attackers published and confirmed genuine Senegalese birth records and national identity cards among them (February 2026), while the agency's communiqués assert only that the integrity of personal data is preserved and are silent on confidentiality. The interior minister said in September 2026 that a general audit had been engaged to assess and strengthen the security of the directorate's system.

The statute now exists and the institutions do not. The National Assembly adopted law n° 25/2026 on the protection of critical information infrastructure and digital security unanimously on 20 August 2026, mandating in-country storage of state-sensitive data, empowering a National Cybersecurity Authority and folding in technology-neutral standards for the AI era and the child-online-protection plan. On the ministry's account it also creates national and sectoral computer emergency response teams and grades obligations on critical operators by risk, with ordinary networks on standard requirements and critical infrastructure on enhanced ones covering monitoring, backup, encryption, continuity and resilience testing. None of those bodies is yet standing, and no promulgation date or gazette reference is published. The policy it lands on is older: the National Cybersecurity Strategy (SNC2022) sets the country's cybersecurity framework, and in March 2026 Senegalese experts were still urging the creation of a national cybersecurity agency, a cyber-observatory and a dedicated cyber task team.

The state's own diagnosis locates the obstacle in its contracting machinery. The procurement regulator ARCOP has been brought into the critical-infrastructure cybersecurity programme, on an account that puts the difficulty in contracting rather than in budget or technical capability, with most public bodies reporting difficulty acquiring the infrastructure, equipment and services they need and the Dakar 2026 Youth Olympic Games named as the exposure window the upgrades have to clear. Nothing comparable is stated for the platform through which those contracts now run: no security assessment, continuity arrangement or manual fallback is on the record for APPEL (July 2026).

Externally the reading is the same. INTERPOL's African Cyberthreat Assessment Report 2026 names Senegal among the continent's ransomware hotspots, with attackers increasingly targeting health institutions, public-service providers and government platforms (August 2026), and its judgement is that legislative progress on cyber risk is outpacing implementation. Senegal scores 67.17 out of 100 on the ITU Global Cybersecurity Index 2024, in Tier 3. The statutory architecture for a national computer emergency response team was adopted on 20 August 2026.

DPI

Data Exchange

The Senegalese state said in August 2026 that its own government platforms remain siloed, sixteen months after the national interoperability platform was launched to connect them, naming interoperability of public information systems as a standing challenge. The 2025 GovTech Maturity Index records no government interoperability framework at all: the headline indicator and every one of its five sub-measures — operational standards, data quality, uptime, legacy retirement and public disclosure of the arrangement — are marked absent (2025).

The layer has a name, a technology and a validated plan. It is the Plateforme Nationale d'Interopérabilité du Sénégal, built on X-Road, with a roadmap of pilot in 2024-2025 and national deployment across 2025-2027 validated by the COCOOR inter-ministerial committee in September 2025. What the ministry lists as running on it in its first year is short: Treasury e-payments, government correspondence, the e-Senegal single window, e-Consulat and e-Visa (2026). Two exchanges are stated in production against it: the health-cover body reading social-protection data in real time to automate enrolment in free health insurance, and the tax directorate automatically retrieving customs declarations validated by customs for fiscal reconciliation. The same account states the first phase delivered a national interoperability framework, a sovereign platform and a draft decree — and the decree was still being presented as a draft in May 2026, so the framework operates while the act adopting it does not exist.

The exchange that predates the platform was built one pair of agencies at a time, around shared identifiers rather than a central platform. The NINEA business identifier has underpinned an interconnection between the statistics agency, Customs, the tax directorate, the finance directorate and the Treasury since 2014; customs and tax cross-check each other's data under an automated exchange protocol signed in March 2024; the civil registration and identity file authorities have signed an interoperability convention binding the civil register to the national identity file (2025), the design being a numéro unique linking civil status to identity and biometric records, the courts, health, tax, the electoral roll, travel documents, payroll and social security; and a protocol of January 2026 puts birth, marriage and death data on automated exchange with the statistics agency. Health facilities can now notify the competent civil-status centre at the moment of birth (August 2026).

Senegal is pursuing interoperability through at least four separate efforts run by different bodies — the national platform, a climate-transparency platform, a social-protection information system and a bilateral customs exchange with The Gambia — three of which opened within a single fortnight of July 2026. Joint work on interoperability between the civil registry and public identification was completed and two options put up for arbitration, announced 16 September 2026.

Digital Identity and CRVS

Senegal stopped making national identity cards for eight weeks in 2026. The Direction de l'Automatisation des Fichiers suspended production on 5 February after acknowledging an intrusion into its systems and resumed on 1 April. The official communiqués assert that the register's data integrity remains intact and say nothing about its confidentiality, which is the question the leak raises. In September the directorate's head confirmed that the incident

was a cyberattack and said no personal data had been compromised, with no technical accounting behind the statement; a security researcher who examined the samples the attackers published confirmed that genuine Senegalese birth records and identity cards were among them.

The credential is the ECOWAS biometric card, with the DAF running the biometric population register and issuing national identity cards, passports and residence documents. It was established by Law No. 2016-09 of 14 March 2016, may be obtained from the age of five and is compulsory to hold from fifteen. Holding it is what opens the state: it became the sole accepted proof of identity for voter registration in February 2025, and registration in the social register requires identity verification while the universal health scheme verifies beneficiaries against national identity data, so citizens without a card struggle to obtain either (2023). The New Deal sets digital-ID coverage of more than 90 per cent of citizens as a target rather than a position reached (2026).

What the card does not open is government's own back office: the 2025 index records the public-service HR system and every one of the social insurance system's identity-linkage measures as not using the national ID. No law defines digital identity, and card production and key technical infrastructure sit with Malaysia's Iris Corporation, under an arrangement running since 2016 and renewed in 2021 at US$19.5 million. The interior minister told deputies the contract, last amended on 29 April 2026, runs to 21 May 2027, and said card and passport production would pass progressively to Senegalese firms (September 2026).

Biometric registers are being stood up outside that frame. A physical and biometric audit of the Fonction publique headcount has run since 23 June 2026 with more than 35 auditor teams deployed, with no correction route stated for a state employee it fails to find, and on 30 July 2026 the mines ministry and the Caisse des Dépôts et Consignations signed a convention for the biometric identification of artisanal gold miners and the issue of secure professional cards.

Digital Payments and Fintech

Senegal carried the largest share of UEMOA's mobile-money transaction volume in 2024, 24.1 per cent, up from 22.7 per cent the year before, and grew fastest of the eight member states at 24.79 per cent; on value it was second, at 30.2 per cent against Côte d'Ivoire's 34.7 per cent. Eleven e-money issuing establishments operate in the country, second only to Côte d'Ivoire's nineteen (2024), and 76 per cent of adults hold a mobile money account, on 14.65 million active accounts in 2024. On the central bank's measure, which counts electronic-money accounts, 83.3 per cent of adults used a financial service in 2023, against 61.9 per cent in 2016 and a union average of 71.4 per cent, and the financial-services observatory still put the rate at about 83 per cent in December 2025.

The state's answer to that success has been to tax it. Facing a fiscal shortfall the government proposed a 0.5 per cent levy on mobile-money transfers, plus higher merchant charges, to raise around CFA 220bn over three years under the 2025-2028 Recovery Plan (2025); consumer bodies, fintechs and some lawmakers opposed it as likely to reverse financial-inclusion gains and push users back to cash, proposing instead a tax on operator revenue, a levy on withdrawals only, or progressive taxation of high-value transfers.

The regional rail went live on 30 September 2025, when the central bank launched PI-SPI, giving instant, irrevocable 24/7 transfers between banks, microfinance institutions and electronic money issuers across all eight WAEMU states; nineteen Senegalese institutions are authorised participants (2026). Payment institutions, a licence category the central bank created in January 2024, are the newest entrants: Senegal held 11 of the 31 licensed across the union at the end of February 2026, more than any other member state. Flutterwave obtained a payment institution licence in July 2025, and Wave, which holds an e-money issuer licence, had already broken the 5-10 per cent pricing of the operator wallets with free deposits and withdrawals and a flat 1 per cent transfer fee.

Public money now moves on the same rails. SenTresor, launched on 2 June 2025, digitises state payments of salaries, allowances, social assistance, pensions and scholarships; the entrepreneurship fund DER/FJ disburses and collects repayments through the Orange Money and Wave mobile wallets (July 2026); and the family security grant resumed on 1 October 2026 after a two-year interruption, CFA 140,000 per household for 2026 paid through mobile-money operators; and taxes, duties and fees have been payable through Orange's Max It application since November 2025. Wave was on the instant payment platform's participant list as updated on 30 September 2026.

Registries

Seventy-seven per cent of Senegal's 629 civil-status centres had been digitised by September 2026, the management software deployed in 74 per cent of them and the online certificate platform operating in 189 municipalities as of August. The live register behind it held 15,352,830 records at 13 July 2026, well short of the 20 million acts digitised and indexed out of the archives by August 2025. The flow is smaller again: 112,881 declarations registered through the platform in 2024, and 108,233 in the first half of 2025. The agency's own position is that digitisation secures the paper register rather than replacing it, declarations continuing to be received in centres as the law requires, and it has had to instruct mayors to stop using unauthorised civil-status software (2025).

On coverage, birth registration of children under five reached 81.4 per cent in the 2023 EDS Continue survey, up from just over 50 per cent in 2013, and cross-referenced against the RGPH-5 census 5.3 per cent of the whole population and 8.9 per cent of under-fives hold no birth certificate at all (August 2026).

The economic registers are thinner. The 2016 enterprise census found about 97 per cent of the country's 407,882 economic units operating informally, so the formal registers reach a small minority of activity; firms are identified by a NINEA number applied for through the statistics agency's e-NINEA portal and registered on the OHADA commercial register, with SEN'INFOGREFFE giving online access (2026). On land, the 2022-23 agricultural survey found 97.3 per cent of surveyed parcels with no registered land document; the NICAD parcel identifier is mandatory and unique, with 673,000 parcels mapped at the November 2025 supervision; and the land register is not connected to the national data exchange, the tax directorate's Système de Gestion Foncière being built to interoperate with the communal land information system SIFCOM (late 2025). There is no harmonised national address register (2025), and the national digital addressing project was relaunched on 5 August 2026. The social register has grown from 542,000 households to about one million over 2024.

Sectoral management information systems

Senegal's five main social-protection programmes — the family security grants, universal health cover, the equal opportunity card, the national solidarity fund and the single register — each run on separately built information systems, limiting exchange between them and producing overlapping interventions, on the ministry's own diagnosis of July 2026. It has opened work on an interoperable replacement, convening a two-day workshop to diagnose the existing systems, fix functional and technical requirements and validate a development roadmap, which is the earliest stage of a build.

The revenue and finance machinery is real but isolated. The tax administration runs commercial off-the-shelf software in use that is not connected to other government systems, customs runs its own package with all three of the index's connection and integration measures absent, the financial management information system is still in implementation, covers central government only, and handles treasury functions and budget preparation, and the social insurance and pension systems are in use, with a separate pension system for public employees, and do not interoperate with other government systems (2025).

Below the ministries, the data is still made on paper. Rural health posts, health centres and health huts keep maternal and child health registers that a study of four districts found poorly maintained, with few providers trained to record data in DHIS2 (2025); a World Bank-funded project is extending electronic patient records to six more regions (April 2025). Schools feed the recently established national education information system SIMEN, whose data stakeholders find well organised but incomplete and late from some sub-sectors (2024), alongside a DHIS2-based education pilot launched in two districts in 2024 that produces aggregate rather than facility-level data. In the courts, a UN-funded e-justice pilot at the Pikine-Guédiawaye court, with an installed data centre and network link, became operational from September 2025; its final report records five judicial procedures digitised, the platform deployed in that one court and more than 40 justice-sector professionals trained (August 2026), with a roadmap for possible expansion and no extension to other courts announced. The World Bank's programme document recorded health worker strikes over two and a half years leaving gaps in routine data collection and reporting (2025). The health ministry's sector policy letter named the shared single patient record the flagship of its digitalisation programme, with deployment in progress. At the tax administration the integrated SENTAX platform replaced the ETAX application for large-enterprise taxpayers and became mandatory for all their declarations and payments from 1 September 2026, opening to the Dakar medium-enterprise centres and the regulated-professions centre from 1 October 2026.

The programme's newsletter recorded the Dakar centre opening in August 2022 as its tenth data centre. Its closing newsletter records the programme's handover to the regional community on 8 April 2025.

The gendarmerie hosted a workshop on 2 October 2025 presenting a European-backed tool to help draft and harmonise case files across the gendarmerie, police, customs and justice.

The agriculture ministry launched the nationwide digitalisation of subsidised seed and fertiliser distribution through the ERP Pass application on 9 October 2026; producers are notified by text message, and the minister said the state now holds a digital register of beneficiaries and allocations.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Senegal withdrew the paper fiscal stamp on 20 July 2026, so that only stamps issued through the tax directorate's SenTimbre mobile platform, each carrying a secured QR code, are recognised by public administrations. Making the state's own platform the only officially recognised channel also ended the private digital distribution that had supplied the stamp, and the announcement stated no offline or assisted route for users without a smartphone or an online means of payment.

What a citizen can do online has widened. The e-Senegal single window is operational and handles passport applications, business creation, police-clearance certificates and nationality certificates with online tracking (March 2026), alongside the Senegal Services portal's more than 750 digitised administrative procedures (2023). Businesses contracting with the state got the APPEL e-procurement platform, live since 15 October 2025 to centralise the acquisition procedures of a thousand public administrations, and its generalisation is set for January 2027, with contracting authorities required to load their 2027 procurement plans onto it by 1 December 2026. Motorists got digital fines: 50 processing points across 47 brigades of the police and gendarmerie since 2024. The citizen-facing side of civil registration is furthest behind: 112 of the 437 connected centres had activated the Sama État Civil service as at 17 July 2026, about 26 per cent.

The gaps are as telling as the launches. The 2025 index records the national service portal as transactional, but company formation is not available on it, citizens are not involved in designing it, and it publishes nothing about its own operation; there is no online social protection portal at all. A full inventory of the state's information systems

was launched at the Government Enterprise Architecture workshop of 29 July 2026, but no date, budget or publication commitment attaches to it (August 2026), and the GouvNum steering committee, created to oversee all digital transformation initiatives, was still only due to become operational five months after its creation.

Of the thirty-two headline indicators in the 2025 GovTech index, ten are recorded as absent, and they fall in a pattern: the line-ministry transaction systems for tax, customs, human resources, payroll, social insurance and debt are all in use, while the layer that would connect and govern them is not. The e-Justice programme and the Jokko Ak Yoon platform were launched on 10 September 2026.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

The digital state below the national level amounts, in substance, to one register and three communes. The Agence de Développement Local's E-Territoire programme has validated a national digital-territories master plan and local digital plans for Bargny, Mont-Rolland and Sandiara, with a UNDP-funded US$1.5 million rollout of municipal land-information systems under way in those three pilot communes (2023).

The register is civil status, the only central system that has reached most communes: the civil-status management software covered the majority of the country's centres by mid-July 2026. Installation has run well ahead of operation throughout — a year earlier, much of the installed base was not yet live (August 2025) — and the equipment behind it, from interconnected centres and office computing to motorcycles for communes and communal coordination plans, came through a single programme that closed in June 2026. Where the centre arrived late, communes had already improvised: the national civil registration agency has had to instruct mayors to stop using unauthorised civil-status software in their registration offices (2025).

The registers local administration depends on beyond civil status are weaker. Senegal maintains no harmonised addressing system, which research on Dakar's property tax names among the structural constraints on collecting it (2025). Land rights administration is being digitised on donor money, with KfW financing decentralised infrastructure and equipment to improve access to land use rights and land titles through 2028.

The treasury presented the Koom-Com application at the 2025 Dakar fair: a geolocated taxpayer census through to collection, with a first phase of 125 urban communes said to account for about 80% of local revenue.

Rural digital data capture

Only 3% of rural Senegalese households had an internet connection at the end of 2025, and that figure, not the state of any software, sets the limit on what gets recorded outside Dakar.

At the four points where the state meets a rural citizen, the record is made on paper. Health posts, health centres and health huts keep maternal and child health registers that a study of four districts found poorly maintained, with few providers trained to record data in DHIS2; electronic patient records exist only in a small World Bank-funded pilot (April 2025). Rural primary schools, only 15.4% of which had internet access in 2023 against 41.4% in urban areas, keep enrolment, attendance and teacher data on registers and logs, aggregated through district and regional offices before reaching the national education system, and the DHIS2-based education deployment begun in 2024 remains a district-level research pilot producing aggregate rather than facility-level data. Police and gendarmerie officers must send the original of each procès-verbal to the prosecutor under the Criminal Procedure Code, which names no electronic form; their one digital capability outside the capital is processing forfeitary traffic fines. Registry offices are the uneven exception: the civil-status software runs thinnest in Kédougou, Sédhiou and Tambacounda and close to complete in Thiès, Dakar and Fatick as at mid-July 2026.

The material a rural administration most needs is the least captured. Almost no surveyed agricultural parcel carries a registered land document (2023). In Kédougou, which concentrates nearly all of Senegal's recorded artisanal gold-mining sites, the state ties the absence of traceability to water pollution, insecurity and criminal infiltration of the mining zones (2026). Rural Representation and Participation is Senegal's lowest-ranked of 96 governance indicators, 36th of 54 in 2023 after falling 17.2 points over the decade.

The correction being attempted is satellite rather than cable. The first Starlink kits were handed over in Kolda, in Casamance, on 10 April 2026, a first lot of 200 from 1,000 gifted with two years' subscription, on a tour that ran 9–13 April 2026 through Ziguinchor, Kolda and Kaolack. Rural electrification runs under a national programme with substantial off-grid deployment (2024).

Technology

AI

Senegal's national artificial intelligence plan was still an instruction as at 29 July 2026, when the Council of Ministers recorded the Head of State directing government to accelerate the deployment of a Plan national de développement de l'Intelligence artificielle alongside the digital transformation of schools and universities. In service delivery there is nothing to point to: no artificial intelligence is used in the citizen feedback and citizen-facing service channels (2025).

What exists is a set of priorities and the meetings that produced them. The digital ministry set the country's AI and data priorities with administration, universities and business on 1–2 July 2026, working with Smart Africa and German development cooperation on a national blueprint for creating value from data across health, agriculture, transport, education, taxation and security; the ministry validated the draft blueprint on 21–22 September 2026, with Senegal one of three pilot countries alongside Kenya and Lesotho. The priority use cases identified are French–Wolof and local-language voice translation, remote medical-diagnostic support, mobility, natural-hazard prediction and smart grids (July 2026). A UNESCO readiness assessment names the obstacles: initiatives duplicated across different government structures and slowed by politics and bureaucracy, a deficit of AI skills, and the commercial interests private-sector involvement brings into rule-making.

Deployment, where there is any, is mostly not the state's. The exception is the tax directorate, whose data-mining project builds predictive models to detect anomalies and fraud, with an application tracking how tax offices use the intelligence, reviewed in January 2025. kSanté, an offline AI assistant for community health workers trained on health ministry documents, was launched with the ministry by a social enterprise in July 2025 and was being distributed on 2,000 cards that August. Allo Goor Gi, a Wolof- and French-language AI tutor reachable by ordinary phone call without internet, was presented on 30 July 2026, and two AI research laboratories run at Cheikh Anta Diop University and the Cheikh Hamidou Kane Digital University. The technology also reaches Senegal as a threat, in the AI-drafted impersonation emails INTERPOL records in business-email-compromise cases around Senegal.

The money is external and the doctrine ahead of the budget. The Gates Foundation's September 2025 commitment includes an AI hub for health and agriculture; the Senegalese Cybersecurity Association has called for a dedicated annual AI budget (August 2025), at the same occasion where the armed forces framed AI and digital sovereignty as a pillar of national independence resting on mastery of infrastructure and trained cyber experts. A Senegal AI Factory was presented in Tokyo on 3 August 2026, while the law the technology would run under, a revised personal data protection bill, awaits a vote. An AI application for judicial archives began a pilot at the Pikine-Guediawaye High Court, reported 6 October 2026, and a Korean project-management tender for the Senegal AI Factory was issued on 31 August 2026, with bids closing on 20 October.

The justice ministry judged the pilot's first results satisfactory at a meeting with the UN agency on 9 October 2026, naming staff recruitment and the regular feeding of the court platform as the open challenges.

ICT Industry

Senegalese startups raised about US$84 million in equity across ten deals in 2025, up 137% on the year, and roughly US$223 million including debt, one of only three markets outside Africa's four largest to clear US$50 million in equity. The sector that money sits in is telecoms and payments. Sonatel remains the incumbent around which the rest arranges itself, extending its own super-app into Dakar's bus rapid transit ticketing in July 2026; Wave holds a BCEAO electronic money issuer licence for its transfers and merchant payments; and Senegal hosts one of the densest fields of licensed e-money issuers in the West African monetary union. Foreign entrants keep arriving on that same ground: Flutterwave took a BCEAO payment institution licence in July 2025, and American development finance has backed a US logistics-technology firm's platform in the market rather than a Senegalese one.

Hardware and premises are thinner. The June 2025 accord with Huawei provides for assembling IT equipment in the country, and the digital technology park at Diamniadio has been under development with African Development Bank financing since 2015, with land still held for private tenants. The people and the paperwork are where the plans are least convincing: public contributor trackers record a small developer community, and company formation and business registration cannot be done through the national service portal (2025). Set against the New Deal's 2034 targets for direct jobs and a share of GDP, that is the distance to be covered. The telecommunications ministry signed a US$150m partnership convention on 6 October 2026 for local production of electronic devices; no financing schedule or site is stated.

Innovation ecosystem

Senegal's startup regime only became operational in 2025, when the implementing decree was adopted in January five years after Law No. 2020-01 of 6 January 2020 on the creation and promotion of startups was passed, and the labelling process it establishes was launched during the New Deal's first year.

The financing side is state-led and recent. DER/FJ, the state's entrepreneurship-finance vehicle, works through partnerships with private operators, signing a digital inclusion and innovation pact with Sonatel in March 2025 under which the Bambey digital campus becomes an innovation hub, putting entrepreneurship support outside Dakar, and Korean cooperation has funded a start-up incubation centre and makerspace at ISEP Diamniadio. What the state has not built is the research end: the Fonds national de promotion de la recherche et de l'innovation and a Conseil national de la Recherche et de l'Innovation were asked for at the Council of Ministers of 29 July 2026 with no statute, budget or date set for either.

The measured picture is modest. Senegal ranked 92nd in WIPO's Global Innovation Index 2024, of around 130 economies. The World Bank's 2025 GovTech assessment finds an established public-sector innovation institution backed by both a strategy and a programme, with digital skills as its focus, while recording no startup financing or SME support measures and neither a government open source policy nor any open source adoption — which closes the cheapest way into public technology to exactly the developers the sector is meant to be producing. The clearest thing the system has absorbed remains Wave, whose flat pricing broke the operator wallets' charges and carried it to Francophone Africa's first unicorn valuation.

Capacity

Literacy

Senegal has the teaching staff and not the completions. Human Resources in Education is its fourth best-scoring governance measure, at 94.5 out of 100 and eighth of 54 in Africa, essentially unchanged across the decade (2023), while education as a whole is one of its three weakest sub-categories at 53.0, 26th of 54 despite a 3.9-point rise over ten years, held down by enrolment at 35.1 and completion at 29.7 — 35th and 33rd, and both among the country's ten worst-scoring indicators (2023). Access to the schooling that exists is unusually even by African standards: Senegal ranks fifth of 54 on equality in education at 73.3, up 8.3 points over 2014–2023.

Where the digital layer meets that system, what exists so far is instructions and memoranda rather than delivery. The Head of State asked government on 29 July 2026 to accelerate the digital transformation of the education system and of higher-education institutions; the education ministry and the Sonatel Foundation agreed in March 2025 to work on putting digital tools into schools and widening access to them; and the national plan on online child protection names digital education in schools and awareness campaigns in national languages among its delivery mechanisms. Administratively, the ministry launched PLANETE 3, a national school-management platform with modules for pupils, parents and teachers, on 3 October 2025, and the civil-registration agency has agreed with the early-childhood agency a check-and-regularise step for undocumented children at preschool entry (August 2026), which puts the school gate at the front of the identity system rather than behind it.

The delivered digital-literacy work is small and regional. Finance 4 All, running from June 2024 to July 2026, trained 265 civil-society trainers across 12 organisations in Dakar and Thiès in digital financial education. Outside the state, the national literacy coalition presses for literacy teaching in national languages to be paired with basic digital skills, delivered through tools that work where connections are poor.

Training and skills

The largest delivered headcount is FORCE-N's: run by the Cheikh Hamidou Kane Digital University with the Mastercard Foundation since 2021, it reported more than 100,000 young people certified in digital trades across all fourteen regions, and more than 91,000 supported into work, by June 2026. Civil registration has its own: 2,318 people had been trained on the civil-status management software across 599 centres by 17 July 2026 — 1,485 agents and 833 registrars. The headline ambition is an order of magnitude larger: the New Deal commits Senegal to training 5,000 certified digital experts a year to 2034.

What sits between the two is a series of separately sponsored cohorts. Alibaba is to train around 100 Senegalese cloud engineers under the Dakar 2026 sovereign-cloud arrangement (April 2026), and the June 2025 accord with Huawei commits to skills transfer in cloud computing, artificial intelligence and 5G. Several hundred blind and low-vision Senegalese have been through an advanced IT and AI course run by the STMicroelectronics Foundation with the ITU (July 2026). Government's own offering is narrower than either: a digital skills programme for public servants covering basic skills, which does not extend to citizens and schools (2025).

The tertiary and vocational pipeline is largely donor-built. Korean cooperation funded the ISEP technical college at Diamniadio, with ICT laboratory equipment, faculty training and curriculum development for vocational ICT education, and later a start-up incubation centre and makerspace on the same campus; digital skills are one of the four components of the World Bank's Senegal Digital Economy Acceleration Project, running 2023–2028, and an enabler in the Mastercard Foundation's youth employment commitment to 2030.

Teachers who have used the tools want them: an AI and digital-skills pilot for teaching staff at Mont-Rolland is cited by the literacy coalition as showing real appetite, limited by equipment, connection quality and the absence of pedagogical content adapted to local realities (August 2026). At the other end of the pipeline, a deficit of AI skills is named as one of three obstacles to Senegal making AI rules at all. A digital training plan for state employees was validated at a national workshop on 10 September 2026.

Research institutions

Knowledge is produced here at university scale and not yet at state scale. Cheikh Anta Diop University and the Cheikh Hamidou Kane Digital University run two AI research laboratories, ALIVE and DiCentre4AI, launched under the AI4D programme with applications in agriculture, education and industry (January 2025). They are the working end of an agenda the national instruments have not caught up with: the 2023 AI strategy counts research, innovation and technology transfer among its orientations, and the cybersecurity association has called for a dedicated annual AI budget together with collaboration between the state, the army, universities and civil society (August 2025).

The funding and coordination architecture is not adopted. A Fonds national de promotion de la recherche et de l'innovation, and a network of applied research laboratories, were asked for at the Council of Ministers of 29 July 2026 with no budget, no statute and no date set for either, and a Conseil national de la Recherche et de l'Innovation is at the stage of réflexion, the same Council having asked only that the idea be considered. Neither is an adopted instrument as at 29 July 2026.

The one standing national body in the field is long-established rather than new. The Académie nationale des Sciences et Techniques du Sénégal was asked at that Council to be given increased means of intervention, so that it can contribute to delivering the projects and reforms of the Sénégal 2050 agenda, and to expand its role in those reforms — an instruction carrying no figure. On the international measure of innovation performance, Senegal sits in the lower third of the economies ranked (2024).

Inclusion

Access to services

Senegal withdrew the paper fiscal stamp on 20 July 2026 and named no offline or assisted route to the digital replacement, and published no adoption figure, leaving anyone without a smartphone or a means of paying online with no stated way to obtain one. Days later the private app that had distributed the same stamp free for six years suspended the service and began refunding its users, leaving the state platform as the only channel for a document that is required.

The measured direction of travel is downward. Equal Access to Public Services scored 54.1 out of 100 in 2023, fourteenth of 54 African countries, after falling 11.9 points over 2014–2023 — one of the few governance measures on which Senegal has lost ground. For persons with disabilities the legal route is unfinished: the 2010 social orientation law covers their access to ICT, but only two of its fourteen implementing decrees had been signed, and Senegal had not ratified the Marrakesh Treaty (2025).

The counter, not the browser, is still the working point of access. The New Deal Technologique targets at least 95 per cent quality and affordable connectivity by 2034, and until then the state reaches people through Espaces Sénégal Services, the department-level counters over which a convention announced in July 2026 would also deliver universal health cover. Online, the state's reach is narrower than the strategy implies: there is no citizen-facing social protection portal at all, and access to the subsidised programmes runs through the identity card, since enrolment in the social register and verification for universal health cover both turn on it.

The most interesting design response drops the connection requirement rather than working around it: Allo Goor Gi, presented on 30 July 2026, is a Wolof- and French-language AI tutor reachable on an ordinary phone call, with no internet connection. The National Assembly opened a commission of inquiry into the student-computer programme by 129 votes to none on 20 August 2026, and the Council of Ministers ordered an information system for monitoring and handling citizens' concerns on 10 September 2026.

The commission of inquiry opened its hearings on 5 October 2026; a former funding director testified that the 2025-26 handover recorded an order for 25,000 computers from two suppliers without the contracts.

Digital divides

The sharpest line in Senegal is administrative and geographic: deployment of the civil-status software had reached 98 per cent of centres in Thiès, 92 per cent in Dakar and 90 per cent in Fatick by mid-July 2026, against 42 per cent in Kédougou, 44 per cent in Sédhiou and 47 per cent in Tambacounda. The system arrived last in the south and the east, where the share of pupils without civil-status documents was already highest, at 50.9 per cent in Sédhiou (2021).

The gender line, by contrast, is unusually narrow. 78 per cent of men and 66 per cent of women used mobile internet in 2024, a gender gap of 15 per cent against a sub-Saharan African average of 29 per cent, and women's adoption grew faster than men's over the year. The regulator's own household survey, fieldwork September to October 2024, found women ahead, 59.7 per cent having used the internet in the previous thirty days against 50.8 per cent of men, and 19.4 per cent of households with a home internet subscription, 43.8 per cent in Dakar and about 3 per cent in rural areas, with 65.6 per cent of unconnected households citing the price. The divide that matters is not who is covered but who uses what is there: 4G reaches almost the whole population, and most of the people inside that footprint are not on mobile internet at all. The price of a handset is the principal brake on further growth, which makes affordability, not build, the operative constraint — and rural household internet connections were still marginal at the end of 2025, even as free-connectivity kits began reaching Casamance in April 2026.

On the comparative measures Senegal reads as a strikingly equal society: Equal Socioeconomic Opportunity scored 87.9 out of 100 in 2023, second of 54 African countries and up 10.2 points over the decade, the country's second-strongest governance measure continent-wide. The same profile puts access to banking among its ten weakest and internet and computers at 37.0 out of 100.0, 21st of 54. Opportunity is distributed evenly; the infrastructure that would carry it is not.

Data

National statistics

Senegal's statistical system is better at using data than at producing it: on the World Bank's 2023 Statistical Performance Indicators it scores above 89% for data use, between 70% and 89% for data services, data products and data infrastructure, and only 50% to 69% for data sources — the censuses and surveys everything else rests on, and the system's weakest pillar. The Ibrahim Index puts the capacity of the statistical system at 61.1 out of 100.0 in 2023, 13th of 54 African countries and 12.5 points higher than a decade earlier.

The weakness is not in the headline exercises. Population, agricultural and business censuses have all been held within the past ten years, alongside three or more household, labour force, health and agricultural surveys (2023). Business statistics are the exception: one business survey in the same period, and the general census of enterprises dates from 2016. ANSD catalogues the microdata of its surveys and censuses in a national data archive (2026), and signed a protocol with ANEC in January 2026 for automated exchange of birth, marriage and death data to support demographic planning.

Climate data is where the state says the gap out loud. The environment ministry states that persistent gaps in the availability, quality, harmonisation and inter-sectoral sharing of climate data limit the country's ability to demonstrate what its policies achieve and to mobilise international climate finance (July 2026), and Senegal's own project document records capacity insufficient to comply with the Enhanced Transparency Framework of Article 13 of the Paris Agreement (2025). The country has nonetheless filed three national communications and one biennial update report, and technically validated its third nationally determined contribution. CBIT-Sénégal launched in Dakar in July 2026, funded by the Global Environment Facility with UNEP support, to build an integrated national transparency platform centralising, harmonising, securing and publishing climate data, technical modules from greenhouse-gas emissions to loss and damage, and the embedding of the platform in national planning and international reporting.

Open data

Senegal adopted an access to information law, Loi n° 2025-15, in August 2025, welcomed by ARTICLE 19 as a transparency measure. It arrives on a record of disclosure moving the wrong way: the Ibrahim Index scores the country 53.7 out of 100.0 for accessibility of public records in 2023, 7th of 54 and up 12.4 points over the decade, but 33.9 for disclosure of public records, 26th of 54 and down 2.8.

What actually reaches the public is uneven by subject. The 2024 Open Data Inventory scores Senegal 8 out of 10 for banking, national accounts and price statistics and 7.5 for balance of payments, but 5 for trade and 4 for labour; 8.5 for health facilities and reproductive health and 8 for education facilities, against 6 for gender statistics and 5.5 for both population statistics and education outcomes; and 8 for natural resources, 7 for agriculture and for pollution, 6.5 for energy and 6 for the built environment. Facility counts and financial aggregates are the best served; the population, labour and outcome data that would let an outsider check results are the thinnest.

The open data portal's catalogue holds basic information and datasets rather than a comprehensive collection (2025), and compliance with the data protection regime is not monitored, with no compliance reporting published. A full inventory of the state's information systems was launched at the Government Enterprise Architecture workshop of 29 July 2026, with no scope, deadline or publication commitment attached to it.

Across every part of the GovTech estate the index examines, nothing is published: ten disclosure and transparency sub-indicators — covering cloud hosting, interoperability, the service portal, procurement, debt, the digital transformation strategy, data governance, digital skills, the GovTech institution and the data protection regime — are all recorded as absent for 2025, and the eleventh, the data protection authority's own documentation, exists only internally.

Use of satellite data

Senegal had no national space or geospatial agency and no policy on Earth observation as at August 2026, and satellite imagery had no established role in the cadastre, in agricultural monitoring or in disaster response.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

The first Starlink kits were handed over in Kolda, in Casamance, on 10 April 2026, out of 1,000 the operator gifted with two years' subscription, a first lot of 200 ready to distribute. The company works under a five-year renewable licence whose terms reach data sovereignty, cybersecurity and the protection of local operators, and the state has separately negotiated 5,000 kits at a preferential price, aimed at connecting a million people free of charge (February 2026).

The hyperscalers arrived earlier and more quietly. AWS made a Wavelength Zone in Dakar generally available in April 2025 with Sonatel, the first in West Africa. Google's position rests on a memorandum of understanding signed in October 2024 for a sovereign cloud keeping the state's critical data hosted onshore — a document rather than a deployment.

The older aid channel has shut and the newer one runs through American companies. USAID's Health Systems Strengthening Plus activity, which carried DHIS2 implementation and health data use for PEPFAR reporting, ran from 2016 to 2023 and is closed. The US International Development Finance Corporation's lending in the sector went to a direct loan to QuantumID Technologies to expand its SmartKargo e-commerce, logistics and cargo-tracking platform in Senegal (2024), a Massachusetts firm operating in the country rather than a Senegalese borrower.

What Senegal is asking of Washington is now on the record. On 24 July 2026 the Minister of Telecommunications and Digital Affairs pitched the New Deal Technologique at the US Chamber of Commerce and held working sessions with the State Department and the DFC, covering digital sovereignty, digital public infrastructure, administrative digitalisation, cybersecurity and AI, with the DFC discussion scoped to financing mechanisms for digital infrastructure, data centres, connectivity, digital identity and payments. Counterparties and an agenda, without a signature.

The health ministry signed a health cooperation protocol with the United States on 13 March 2026, and on 13 October 2026 majority deputies filed a proposal for a parliamentary commission of inquiry into the protection of Senegalese personal data under it; the Assembly's Bureau has yet to rule on its admissibility.

China activities

A strategic accord signed with Huawei in June 2025, during Prime Minister Ousmane Sonko's visit to China, puts modernisation of Senegal's data centres first — performance, cybersecurity and green technology — and provides for a domestic plant assembling IT equipment. Talks in March 2025 had ranged wider, over 5G, a sovereign cloud and low-cost smartphones to widen device ownership.

The layer beneath that accord is already Chinese-built. Three phases of an e-government programme financed by China Eximbank from 2007 laid about 1,500 km of fibre optic cable across the regional capitals and built the government intranet and its data centres, implemented by Huawei and CMEC. Smart Senegal followed on 8 February 2018, its first phase funding Safe City surveillance, Smart Education, "Maisons du Citoyen" in every department, a submarine cable landing and public wifi against the digital isolation of territories; its second is restructuring and expanding the Diamniadio national data centre, the Tier 3 facility Huawei built under Chinese financing and inaugurated in June 2021, to centralise government data and platforms previously hosted on foreign servers.

That build was framed on a Chinese model. After the centre opened in June 2021, President Macky Sall instructed the government to migrate all state data and digital platforms to it and repatriate national data hosted outside Senegal, which Georgetown's Africa-China Initiative reads as replicating China's model of housing all servers within national borders; its researchers read the outcome as sovereignty of place rather than of technology, the facility financed by a Chinese policy bank and built by a Chinese vendor on whom its operation continues to depend.

A second Chinese vendor has since entered the same ground. Alibaba is designing and deploying a sovereign cloud with Senegalese engineers to hold sensitive national data onshore, and to run accreditation, security and logistics for the Dakar 2026 Youth Olympic Games (April 2026), with training for Senegalese cloud engineers attached. Beyond Senegal's borders, China handed over the ECOWAS headquarters building in Abuja on 28 April 2026, the second international-organisation complex it has built in Africa after the African Union Conference Centre.

EU activities

Europe's answer to Starlink runs through a teleport built in 1972. Sonatel upgraded Gandoul, in Thiès, in July 2026 with 16 new antennas and a Tier III technical room, turning it into a gateway linking Eutelsat OneWeb's low-earth-orbit constellation to Senegal's terrestrial networks, six months after the same operator launched Senegal's first satellite internet offer on Eutelsat's Konnect service (January 2026).

The EU's civil-registration work has run its course. Nékkal, executed by Civipol and Enabel with the Agence nationale de l'état civil as implementing agency, held its final steering committee on 29 June 2026, after digitising the civil register and interconnecting civil-status centres with the stated aim of improving citizens' access to rights and the evidence base for public policy.

What continues is thinner and aimed at rules rather than systems. GOIN'Digital runs from 2023 to 2029 on governance of the digital sector, its steering and coordination, upgrading the sector's legal framework and feasibility studies for last-mile connectivity. Senegal and Finland opened cooperation on cybersecurity, sovereign and resilient digital infrastructure, data-centre modernisation and AI-ready infrastructure at political consultations in Dakar on 26 March 2026, framed under the New Deal Technologique and the EU's Global Gateway, with misinformation and media literacy among the topics. France is a named partner in digital entrepreneurship, a ministerial visit to DER/FJ in March 2025 reviewing existing partnerships and opening cooperation on technology transfer and funding for digital entrepreneurs.

Senegal's route into international AI rule-making sits outside the EU's channels: it is engaging the Hiroshima AI Process Friends Group, the OECD- and Japan-convened grouping, as the vehicle for its national AI positioning, with discussion covering trustworthy-AI governance, compute infrastructure, innovation financing and international partnerships (August 2026).

Gulf/UAE activities

No Gulf or Emirati digital-sector infrastructure, financing or standing agreement was on the record as at August 2026.

India activities

No Indian digital-sector infrastructure, financing or standing agreement was on the record as at August 2026.

Digital sovereignty

Senegal's National Assembly has voted to keep state data onshore: it adopted law n° 25/2026 unanimously on 20 August 2026, and the bill requires data produced, collected or held by state services, or by private partners carrying out a public-service mission, to be hosted and processed on national territory, allows temporary storage abroad only by regulatory act for a stated period, and makes hosting abroad in breach of that rule an offence (July 2026). The minister told the examining committees that exceptions are provided because of the country's technological dependence, that onshore storage will come from state-owned facilities and from private cloud providers approved

by the national cybersecurity authority, and that hosting rules for other data will be set by decree (August 2026); the commissioners asked what guarantees cover sensitive data entrusted to the foreign firms that make national identity cards and driving licences.

State hosting runs across three SENUM data centres: Orana, built in 2004, Technopole, built in 2008, and Diamniadio, built in 2021, and the civil-status register's data is to be backed up at SENUM's data centre (August 2026). The newest layer is a vendor's stack: the ministry took formal delivery on 24 March 2026 of a national cloud built by Alibaba Cloud on its Apsara Stack product, under a contract signed in Hangzhou on 28 July 2025, to host the Youth Olympic Games' applications and to become the foundation of a national public cloud open to the public and private sectors.

The prime minister's general policy statement of 8 September 2026 makes a sovereign cloud hosting the state's sensitive data on Senegalese soil the central axis of the digital programme, and treats the state's data and essential systems as national-defence assets. The terms on which the Iris Corporation identity contract, the Alibaba cloud contract, the June 2025 Huawei accord and the October 2024 Google memorandum govern data jurisdiction, portability and exit had not been published as at September 2026.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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